

Karan Thakur

Senior Scrum Master

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Professional Scrum Master with 2 years of industry experience of working in the **Healthcare, marketplace and insurance** domain. **Served as an Agile Coach** and have proved to be an excellent liaison between the business and the scrum team with extensive functional and technical industry experience. Excellent **work ethics** coupled with **excellent communication, written and interpersonal skills**, applying **expert judgment** to the **removal of impediments, keeping teams focused** and delivering success in rapidly **evolving and dynamic environments**.

Professional Summary

- Expertise in facilitating SAFe and scrum meetings like **Sprint Planning**, grooming **Product Backlog** and **User Story Prioritization** using **MoSCoW in Backlog Grooming, Daily Standup, Sprint Review, Sprint Retrospective, SOS, PI Planning, System Demo**.
- Helped organizations implement **Scrum** and **SAFe**, managed teams in different time zones in Agile environments.
- Excellent understanding of **Project management, Agile and Scrum principles** as described by PMI.
- Effective in finding out **Upstream and Downstream dependencies** in **PI planning** and facilitating team interaction.
- Improved **Team Velocity** by incorporating **Capacity Planning** into sprint planning sessions. Ensured continuous improvement of the teams for making an **Action Plan** after the retrospectives.
- Experience in accumulating requirements via various **Elicitation Techniques** like **Interviews, Focus groups, Brainstorming** and performing **GAP Analysis, Impact Analysis, Risk Analysis, Root-Cause Analysis, Cause-Effect Analysis, Cost-Benefit Analysis, Feasibility Analysis** to create valuable documentation.
- Extensive experience in creating Meticulous **Artifacts** like **BRD, SRS, FRD, FSD, Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM), HLD & LLD** and facilitating **JAD sessions and triage calls**.
- Proficient in developing **UML diagrams** such as **Use Case diagrams, Activity Flow diagrams, Data Flow diagrams, flowcharts, BPM diagrams, Swimlane diagrams** along with wireframes and prototypes such as screen **Mockups** using **MS Visio, Balsamiq** and **Reports** using **Visualization Tools** like **Tableau and Power BI**.
- Experience in defining **IT Services** and develop processes to manage, protect and measure the **ServiceNow Service**.
- Experience using **SharePoint, JIRA, Rally, Azure DevOps, MS Project** for status reporting, **KPI tracking** and **Dependency Mapping**.
- Proficient in executing **Structured Query Language (SQL)** queries to perform **Data validation** in **Data Warehouse and Data Marts, Data Schemas** in **Database** and **Data Warehouse**.
- Rich experience with **RESTful and SOAP API integration, API mapping, API testing, web service, Microservice**.
- Actively involved in **Data Mapping, Data Analysis, Data Extraction/Transformation/Loading (ETL)** using **Informatica and SSIS** to conduct **ETL process** and **Business Intelligence Reporting** using **Tableau and Power BI**.
- Sound knowledge of **Test Management** tools such as **Swagger, Postman, SOAP UI** to validate the test results and have In-depth knowledge of **Test & Behavior & Acceptance Driven Development (TDD, BDD, ATDD)** also performed **Reverse Engineering** for the enhancement projects to find **Design** and fix **Bugs**.

Technical Skills

Methodologies	Waterfall, Agile, Hybrid
Framework	SAFe, Kanban, Scrum
BI Tools	Tableau, Power BI
Modeling Tools	MS Visio, Lucid Charts, Balsamiq
Databases	MS SQL Server 2012/2016, Oracle 12c, SSIS,
Dev. Environments / Protocols	SOA, CI-CD, Dev Ops, TDD, ATDD, BDD
Documentation Tools	MS Office Suite, SharePoint, Confluence, MS Access, MS Excel
Web Technologies	XML, JSON, HTML, SOAP, RESTful
Project management tools	Rally, JIRA, MS SharePoint, Confluence, Azure DevOps
Testing tools	Swagger , Soap UI, Postman, Jenkins, Selenium, HP ALM

Certification

Professional Scrum Master (PSM-1) | Certification Authority: scrum.org

SAFe Certified Scrum Master (SASM 5.0) | Certification Authority: Scaled Agile

Professional Experience

Client: Prudential	Project: Legacy pipelines migration and Vulnerability Management
Role: Technical Scrum Master	Dates: November 2022 – October 2023

Responsibilities:

- Responsible for **instituting agile processes** and creating strategic and tactical checkpoints to monitor and control the process across multiple projects.
- **Trained, Coached, and mentored** teams in Agile Scrum Methodologies, and continued to mature the existing agile teams.
- Introduced and led implementations of **Agile values, principles, and practices** into an organization.
- Responsible for **facilitating** the **daily stand-ups** and scrum ceremonies like **Grooming, Planning, Review (demo) and Retrospective meetings for multiple teams.**
- Ensured a consistent implementation of Agile processes which included strategic activities like **Enterprise Agile Planning, Sprint 0, requirement hierarchy, workflow/process improvement** as well as tactical activities like **dashboards in Azure DevOps to manage releases and status meetings** .
- Established the rules of engagement for agile practices for all the stakeholders and coached both Engineering and Business resources about agile practices.
- Provided orientation for newly on-boarded business resources on writing user stories and acceptance criteria, the requirement hierarchy (**Capabilities-Features-Stories-Tasks**) and backlog maintenance (**prioritizing and grooming**) Using Azure DevOps PM Tool.
- Helped **product owners in creating user stories** and in prioritizing using techniques like MoSCoW.
- Proactively identified gaps by performing **GAP Analysis** and consulted **Subject Matter Experts (SME)** to better elicit business requirements.

- Occasionally stepped in to fill the responsibilities of a **Product Owner (proxy PO)** like writing user stories, conducting UAT and raising bugs during transition of business resources.
- Developed enterprise-wide metrics like **burn down charts** (epic, release, and sprint), velocity, sprint reports, cumulative flow diagram, control charts (to measure throughput/cycle time).
- Bridged agile-waterfall gap in projects that were transitioning by creating mutually acceptable tracking and monitoring tools like **Milestones, Work Breakdown Structure (WBS), Resource Breakdown Structure, Critical Path Analysis (CPA), Gantt Charts, and PERT Charts.**
- Assisted with **User Acceptance Testing (UAT)** in each sprint, to ensure that the product increment is devoid of technical debt, satisfying criteria of **Minimum Viable Product (MVP)** and **Definition of Done**, as per business need.
- Assisted QA team with Manual Testing, assisting with creating artifacts like **test plans, test summary reports, test scenarios, test steps, test results, defect tracking, bug and defect mitigation strategies, Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM),** ensuring **Acceptance Test-Driven Development (ATDD)** practices are implemented.
- Worked diligently on **Change Request Management** and performed **Impact Analysis** as well as **Capacity and Velocity** planning.
- Reviewed Existing Processes in **ServiceNow** to identify areas of improvements and enhancements.
- Worked on **ServiceNow Modules** like Incident Management, Reporting and Discovery.
- Explored **UDDI** for **WSDL, WADL** for existing **SOAP** and **REST web services, REST APIs** to understand **request and response.**
- **Client-Side, Server-Side and Database** Validations have been written for various functionalities.
- Implemented the methodology of '**Pair Programming**' for **improving team velocity** by reducing the possibilities of bugs.
- Worked on **Enablers** and **Spike stories** and **assigned story points** by convincing the team so that **sprint goal** is completed within schedule.
- Implemented **Service Strategy, Service Design, Service Transition, Service Operation, Continual Service Improvement** using **ServiceNow** as a part of **ITIL** and **ITSM.**

Environment: Agile framework, UML, VISIO, Oracle, SQL Server, Excel, SoapUI, SOAP, REST, XML, SOAP, WSDL, WADL, FHIR, MS-Office, Azure DevOps, XML spy, IBM Business Process Manager, ServiceNow, SharePoint

Client:Walgreens	Project: Automatic appointment scheduling
Role: Technical Scrum Master	Dates: October 2021 – October 2022

Responsibilities

- Performed duties as a **Servant-Leader and coached teams** by communicating with the **Product Owner** on a non-technical level, and with the development team on a more technical level.
- Established **team level cadence** and drove **team level ceremonies (Sprint Planning meeting, Daily scrum meeting, Sprint retrospective meeting, Sprint review meeting and backlog refinement meeting)**
- Facilitated **PI** and **Iteration Planning** sessions and ensured that the **Iteration Backlog** was updated, and the committed velocity of the team was met to ensure delivery of the **MVP**
- Facilitated the **sprint planning sessions** for estimation of prioritized user stories and record them in the sprint backlog from the product backlog once the **definition of ready (DOR)** was met.
- Ensured that the user stories in the **backlog** are prioritized and estimated, which includes scheduling and facilitating the **planning poker** sessions.

- Facilitated **Sprint Review** sessions to corroborate that the **Definition of Done (DoD)** was met with focus on the product being **well-tested and built** as per the acceptance criteria specified by the Product Owner during the System Demo.
- Coordinated with **off-shore** and **off-site team members** during **daily stand-ups** and various **touch-point meetings**.
- Estimated the **capacity** and **velocity** of the team to gauge the number of **user stories** to be accommodated in each sprint based on their priority and business needs.
- Reviewed the **User Stories** with scrum team to identify the gaps in the **Acceptance Criteria** with **Gherkin** format and update them as required.
- Worked with the development team to access the **UDDI** to look up the element provided by the web service by analyzing the **WSDL** to identify the **web services** which best suited requirements.
- Assisted **technical team** during **client-side, server-side validations, database side validation** for accessing information from database.
- tested **APIs** using **Postman** needed for the project and was involved in developing **Service Level Agreements (SLAs)** for the same.
- Recorded the user stories in **JIRA** and allocated the tasks to the dev team and monitored their status using **KPIs** such as **burndown charts** for team performance.
- Solved impediments faced by the developers and testers during the **daily stand-ups** and facilitated **Parking Lot sessions** for issues which needed further assistance and clarification from the BA.
- Worked with business analysts to examine **APIs** needed for the project and so that **Service Level Agreements (SLAs)** could be developed for the same.
- Helped the development team to understand the **AS-IS and TO-BE** business workflow to provide quality MVP's.
- Good understanding of using **Postman** for checking and validating external **APIs** used in the project in the absence of a technical Business Analyst.
- Facilitated **Agile Retrospective games** for analyzing the positives and negatives of the previous sprint and creating improved environments for the dev team to deliver quality **MVP's** more efficiently.
- Helped the team in understanding the agile concepts and the agile practices to improve the team's delivery.

Environment: Agile – SAFe (Scaled Agile) framework - (HTML/CSS, Java, Oracle), MS Project, draw.io, Office Suite, Jira, Confluence, SharePoint, Tableau, Web Services, API, Microservices, AJAX, SOAP UI,

Education

- Masters in Business Administration majoring in Information systems- University of Toledo(Ohio, USA, 2020)
- Bachelors of Science in Information Technology – Vidyalkar School of Information Technology (Mumbai, India, 2018)